

Cocktail Pods (Reverse Spherification)

Monday, April 28, 2025

10:52 PM

EQUIPMENT

1. [Spherification spoon](#)
2. [Sodium Alginate](#)
3. [Calcium Lactate Gluconate](#)
4. [Xanthan Gum](#)
5. [Ice cube trays](#)
6. [Immersion blender](#)
7. [Digital scale](#)
8. [Kitchen thermometer](#)
9. [Pyrex bowls](#)
10. [Cocktail set](#) (includes Boston shaker, jigger, bar spoon, hawthorne strainer, fine mesh strainer, julep strainer, muddler, cocktail picks)

Reverse Spherification Process

- 5g sodium alginate
 - 1L distilled water
 - Frozen cocktail with calcium lactate gluconate (recipes below)
1. Using an immersion blender, combine sodium alginate and distilled water in a large bowl
 2. Let sit for 24 hours to allow bubbles to dissipate
 3. Create a cocktail and blend in the calcium lactate gluconate
 4. Freeze cocktail in the ice cube trays
 5. Warm the sodium alginate bath to about 125 degrees F and prepare two bowls with cold water
 6. Drop one frozen cocktail pod into the sodium alginate bath and gently stir the water with a spoon (be careful not to touch pod with the spoon until the membrane has formed)
 7. Pick up the pod with a spherification spoon, wipe the bottom of the spoon with a paper towel, and transfer to the first cold water bath
 8. Rinse thoroughly by stirring the water, repeat the process with the second bath
 9. Serve or store in a mason jar filled with a holding liquid made up of the cocktail

(minus the calcium)

10. Enjoy!

Maple Old Fashioned

Makes about 5 pods

- 2oz (60ml) rye whiskey
 - .25oz (7ml) maple syrup
 - 3-4 dashes angostura bitters
 - 1oz (30ml) water
 - 1.8g calcium lactate gluconate (2% of cocktail by weight)
1. Add all ingredients to a small bowl
 2. Blend with an immersion blender (or regular blender)

Boulevardier

Makes about 5-6 pods

- 1oz (30ml) rye whiskey
 - 1oz (30ml) Campari
 - 1oz (30ml) sweet vermouth
 - 1oz (30ml) water
 - 2.2g calcium lactate gluconate (2% of cocktail by weight)
1. Add all ingredients to a small bowl
 2. Blend with an immersion blender (or regular blender)

Whiskey Sour

Makes about 7-8 pods

- 2oz (60ml) rye whiskey
 - .75oz (22ml) strained lemon juice
 - .75oz (22ml) simple syrup
 - 1.75oz (53ml) water
 - 3g calcium lactate gluconate (2% of cocktail by weight)
 - .5g xanthan gum (.3% of cocktail by weight)
1. Add all ingredients to a small bowl
 2. Blend with an immersion blender (or regular blender)